

Display screens with sensors

Makers of Gorilla Glass along with researchers from Polytechnique Montreal are trying to build transparent sensors on display glasses <http://digit.in/TransparentSensors>



World's first E-ink wall clock

E-ink which is usually used in e-book readers like the Kindle is being used on the Twelve24 ClockONE <http://digit.in/eInkClock>

Industry Connect

Blackberry on Z3, the 'designed for India' smartphone

We interview Mr. Sunil Lalvani, Managing Director at BlackBerry India, to get his perspective on what the Z3 has to offer to Indian Customer and why prospective buyers should choose the BlackBerry

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d How are things at BlackBerry India?

Sunil: Exciting times ahead. We are extremely confident that we can turn around BlackBerry. By the end of this fiscal year, we are forecasting our operations to be cash-flow positive. Beyond the monetary milestones, we are also thinking long-term and identifying areas that will help us leapfrog the innovation curve. We also see long-term value in BlackBerry and in five years, we expect to have a major play in the M2M (Machine To Machine) space. BlackBerry is well positioned to lead this charge as it looks to unite people and machines across the Internet of Things – from smartphones to in-vehicle telematics systems, smart appliances and much more. Everything will be connected and we would like to become a major hub of this next important technology wave with QNX.

d BlackBerry Z3 seems to be a very important product launch for BlackBerry India, how are you planning to market it? Are you planning anything special and big to attract attention and create hype among the targeted segment?

Sunil: With the launch of the Z3 we are looking forward to bringing to Indian customers a fantastic device, the first one resulting from our Foxconn partnership. The launch of this product, built for our customers here in India, is a testament to how we are listening to our customers and delivering technologies that meet the needs of our core markets.



Sunil Lalvani, Managing Director, BlackBerry, India

Needless to say we have a 360 degree marketing campaign around it. We have some exciting partnerships in place with The Mobile Store and Flipkart. We also have an aggressive social campaign. Furthermore, we will be rolling out on ground activations across various touchpoints to bring the brand closer to our consumers.

d While we are aware of the price segment that BB Z3 is targeting, can you define who the BB Z3 buyer is? Who is the core audience for the BB Z3 in India?

Sunil: The Z3 is designed with India in mind and for people looking for a smartphone that excels at communications, messaging and productivity. Available at ₹15,990, the Z3 provides a bigger screen, more RAM and longer battery life, bringing BlackBerry 10 in reach of a new generation of Indian customers.

d With the Z3, BB now has 3 BB OS10 based devices in the ₹10-20K price segment, the Z3, Q5 and Z10. Is BB considering the sub ₹10K segment for BB 10 based smartphones?

Sunil: On the devices end, we don't want to adopt the mass market strategy and have never had a play in the sub \$175 segment. Having said that, we have a healthy portfolio of devices across BlackBerry OS 7 and BlackBerry 10 OS. Our strengths lie in creating cutting edge devices that offer superior user experience coupled with great security and we will not dilute that proposition. We will continue to launch BlackBerry 10 smartphones for the 'urban youth' and 'prosumer' and for the first time smartphone adopters; we also have a robust base for the BlackBerry OS 7 devices.

d BlackBerry has always been known for its hardware QWERTY keypads and messaging services. Do you see the same prospective buyer actually adopting to a full touch, large screen BB 10 device, the Z3?

Sunil: The BlackBerry Z3 is built with India in mind. Our customers here love to stay connected; especially when it comes to the latest trends; they look for more ways to connect, share and communicate, and the Z3 is the best tool for secure, reliable communications and collaboration with all. The Z3 gives consumers more ways to connect and share – with a longer-lasting battery.

Having said that BlackBerry is perhaps the only brand today that offers compelling device choices in both touch and QWERTY options straddling an attractive price range for a wide cross section of customers. **d**